

After 12 years in law, Joe decides his profession is no longer enjoyable. Yet, he decides to endure, as he is just one promotion away from making partner and a guaranteed six-figure salary. As Joe's life progresses, he never loses sight of his goal: Retire by age 55 because, after all, financial guru David says, "The smart people finish rich."

Joe saves, works overtime, invests in mutual funds, and participates in his firm's 401K. He continues to endure his job for the sake of the plan. No one said it'd be easy. That "one day" was coming, the day when he'd retire with millions. He justifies that five days of misery in a hated job was worth the sacrifice for the future. Then, one hot summer day while mowing the lawn, Joe has a heart attack and dies at age 51 . . . four years before his destination.

You can either *live rich young* or *live rich old* while risking death along the way. The choice is yours and it shouldn't be a contest. Rich at 25 years old beats the snot out of rich at 65 years old. Ask a youngster how to get rich young. Will coupons, mutual funds, and 401ks be the answer? Comedic, I know.

Wealth is best lived young and enjoyed while you have health, vibrancy, energy, and yes, maybe even some hair. Wealth is best lived in the prime of your life, not in its twilight after 40 years of 50-hour workweeks have pulverized your dreams into surrender. Deep in our soul we know this, yet we continue to faithfully pledge obedience to a financial roadmap that promises wealth after four or five decades.

And the bigger concern you should have is, does it even work? The global recession has exposed the Slowlane for the fraud it is. With no job, the plan fails. When the stock market loses 50% of your savings, the plan fails. When a housing crisis erases 40% of your illiquid net worth in one year, the plan fails. *The plan is a failure because the plan is based on time and factors you can't control.* Unfortunately, millions of people have faithfully invested decades into the plan only to discover the ugly truth: The Slowlane is risky and insufferably impotent.

A strategy that requires your life and your dreams to be paid as penance is a sucker's bet. The Slowlane arrogantly assumes that you will live forever and, of course, be gainfully employed forever. Unfortunately, wheelchairs don't fit in the trunks of Lamborghinis.

SLOWLANE MINDPOSTS AND MISSIVES

Over time, the Slowlaner collects and espouses a series of mindposts reinforced by credible sources. Mom and Dad say go to college, graduate, and get a job. Best-selling author David says, "Stop drinking expensive lattes." Suze says, "Open a Roth IRA and contribute 10% of your paycheck." Ramsey says, "Snowball that debt." All these missives formulate the Slowlaner's mindposts, a journey to wealth that consumes a lifetime.